MOBURST HOME ASSIGNMENT · AI DESIGN LEAD

Till cash back do us part

A campaign for Upside about the everyday couple who never miss a chance to earn. Six parts, from the big idea to the final video, plus the process behind every choice.

Talia Naiman Client: Upside October 2026



PART 1 · CAMPAIGN PLATFORM

The big idea

BIG IDEA

Till cash back do us part

Every couple has one person who will go to any length so nothing slips by. In our world that person runs across the lawn in a robe and rollers because her husband is about to fill up without claiming the offer. Upside turns that small household drama into a vow: you never let cash back go unclaimed again.

KEY MESSAGE

Claim. Pay like always. Earn.

Real cash back on the gas, groceries and dinners you already buy, with no receipts and no change to how you pay. Up to 25¢/gal on gas, $1B+ already earned by Upside users.

Who it's for

Value minded drivers and households, 25 to 55, who fill up every week and shop and eat out locally. They are not

Why it fits Upside

The brand voice is neighborly, trustworthy and clever. Humor from real life, real people and a simple three step product story deliver all three, and they

The thread

A thin Pulse green line runs through every asset and carries you from one moment to the next. It echoes the

coupon hunters. They want a small win that takes no effort.

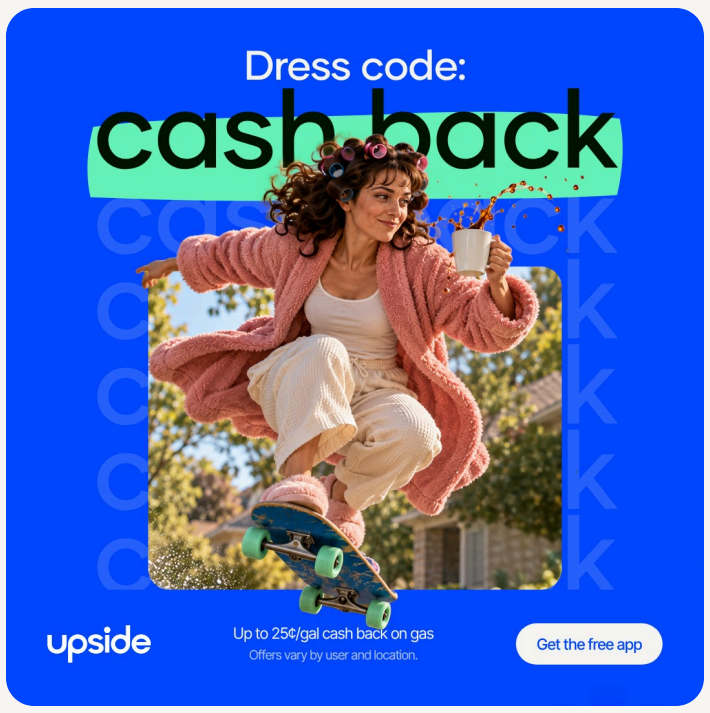
stand apart from a category full of fear driven "gas prices" ads.

cyclical arrow in Upside's icon: money that leaves you and comes back.

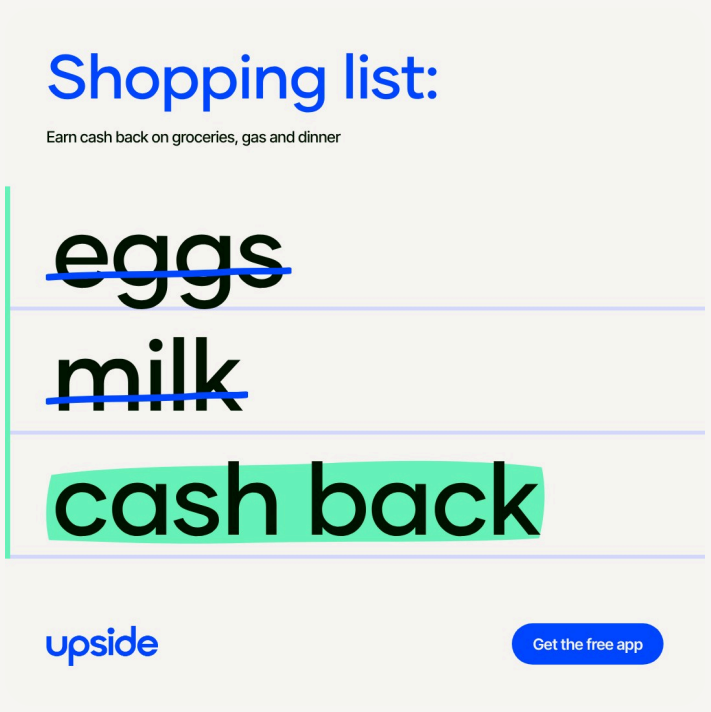
PART 2 · STATIC ADS · 1080×1080

Three ads, three visual approaches

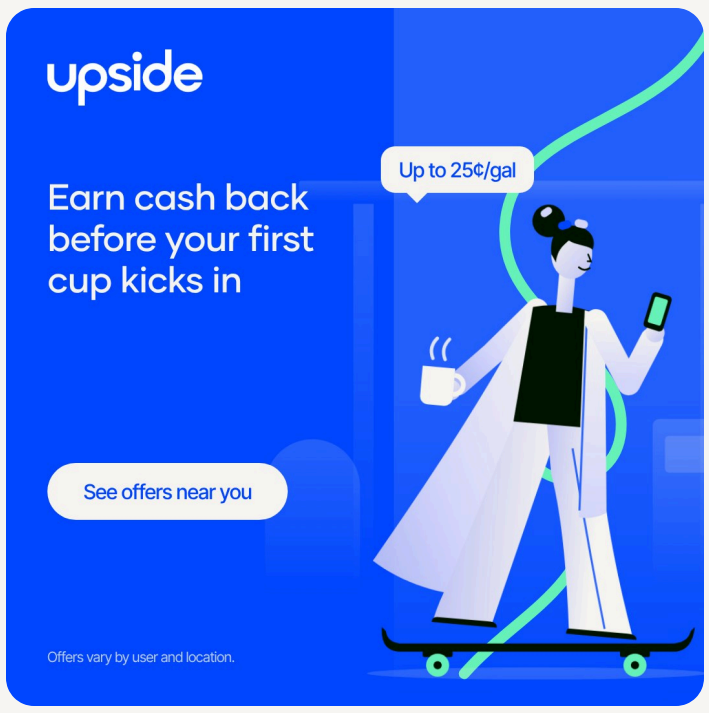
One campaign world, three treatments: lifestyle photography from the film, typography as the hero, and Upside's own vector illustration language. All three share Gilmer Medium headlines, the book wordmark, the Pulse accent and the disclaimer, so they read as one campaign in the feed.



Ad 1 · Photography. A frame from the film composited in Photoshop into a coded brand layout, her head breaking out of the photo card. "Dress code: cash back" with "cash back" on a Pulse marker.



Ad 2 · Typography. A shopping list where eggs and milk get crossed out and "cash back" gets highlighted. No image needed to tell the joke.



Ad 3 · Vector illustration. The film's heroine in Upside's illustration style, with a thin Pulse thread and an offer chip.



Bonus · Motion. The vector direction in motion: kinetic word beats, iris reveals, and a skater and a car that pull the thread into the next scene.

Why three approaches

Each treatment wins a different kind of attention. Photography carries the film's humor and real people, typography stops the scroll with a joke you read in one second, and illustration explains the product with Upside's own visual language. Testing all three tells us which world to invest in.

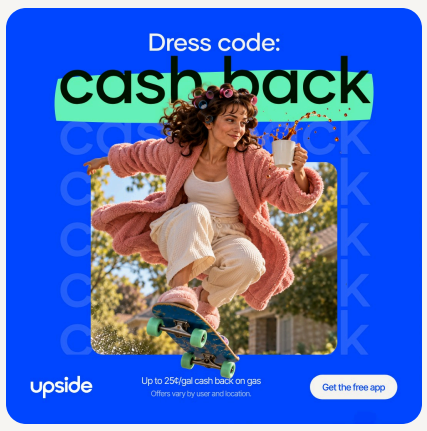
PART 3 · VARIATIONS

Five per ad, generated from one spec

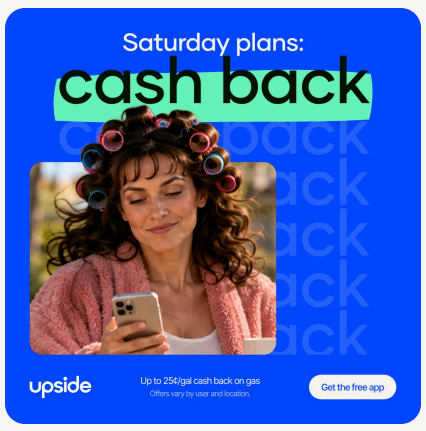
Each ad was turned into a template that keeps the message and brand fixed, and each variation changes what you see: a different moment from the film, a different composition of the same type idea, or a different scene in the illustration world, plus hook copy and colourway. One renderer draws every file, so grid, type and logo cannot drift, and every variation passes an automatic brand check for banned words, spelling and the disclaimer. Each one changes a variable worth testing, which also gives Meta's delivery system genuinely different creatives.

Ad 1 · Photography

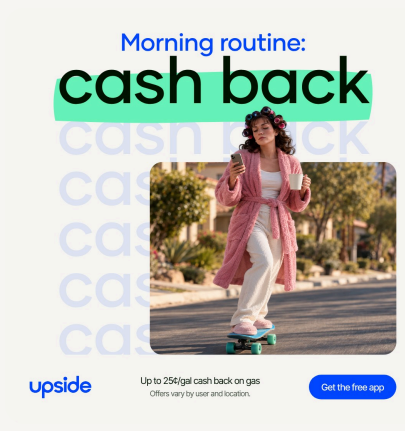
Layouts built as code with the photo card left open, then each film frame composited by hand in Photoshop. The card moves between centre, left and right.



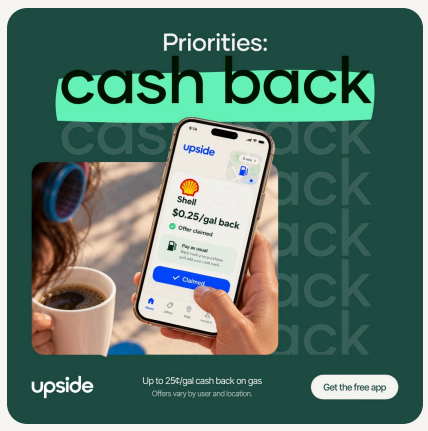
A The jump · Dress code



B The stare · Saturday plans



C The ride · Whitecap

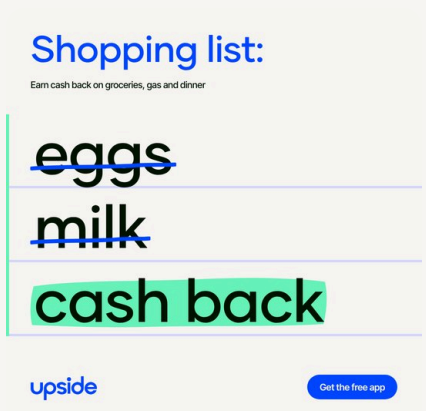


D The claim · Surge

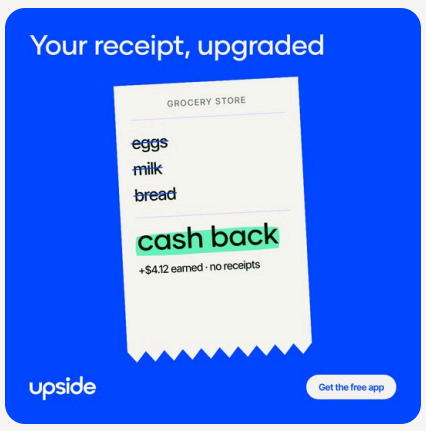


E Dave · offer first

Ad 2 · Typography



A Notebook list



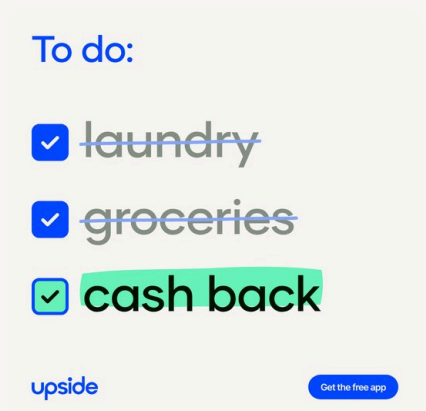
B Receipt



C Sticky note · Surge

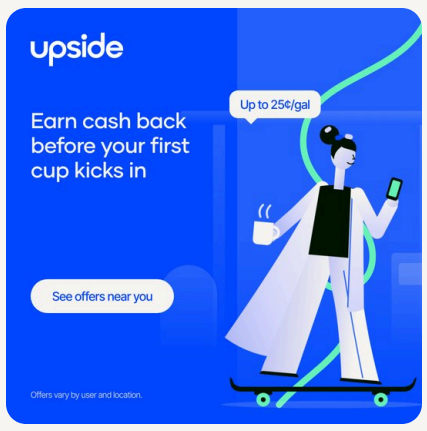


D One giant word

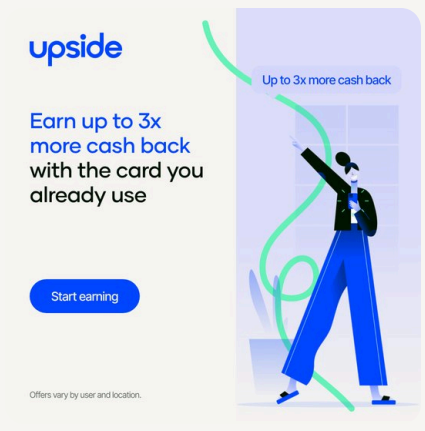


E Checklist

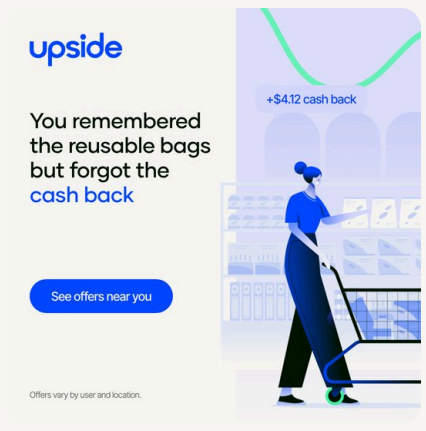
Ad 3 · Vector illustration



A Control · Morning gas



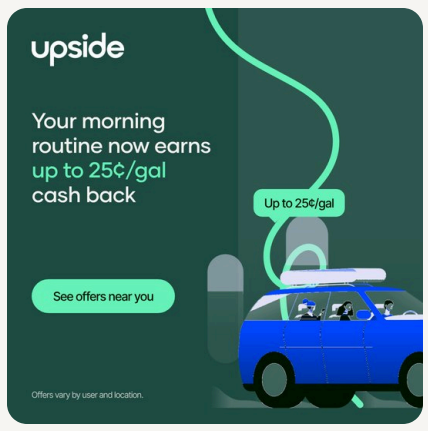
B Stacking · up to 3x



C Groceries



D Dining · Tap Claim



E Commute · Surge

PART 4 · VIDEO STORYBOARD

Six frames: Saturday, 7:02 AM

The couple concept as a 40 second vertical video. The three app steps from the brief (claim, pay, earn) are carried by UI that animates over live action.



Original storyboard, 12 frames. Written and boarded by me before generating any video: the realization, out the door, the hose, the chase, the car in sight, mission complete.

THE FINAL EDIT IN SIX FRAMES



FRAME 1 · SETUP

What happens

She stares out of the window with her coffee. Through the glass, Dave is backing out to fill up.

Copy

"Saturday · 7:02 AM"

Visual idea

Rollers, robe and pure panic. A tracked label follows the car: "Dave's off to fill up".

FRAME 2 · HOOK

What happens

Extreme close up of her face as she realises.

Copy

"Without Upside?"

Visual idea

Blue and Pulse type blocks punch in on the beat.

FRAME 3 · CLAIM

What happens

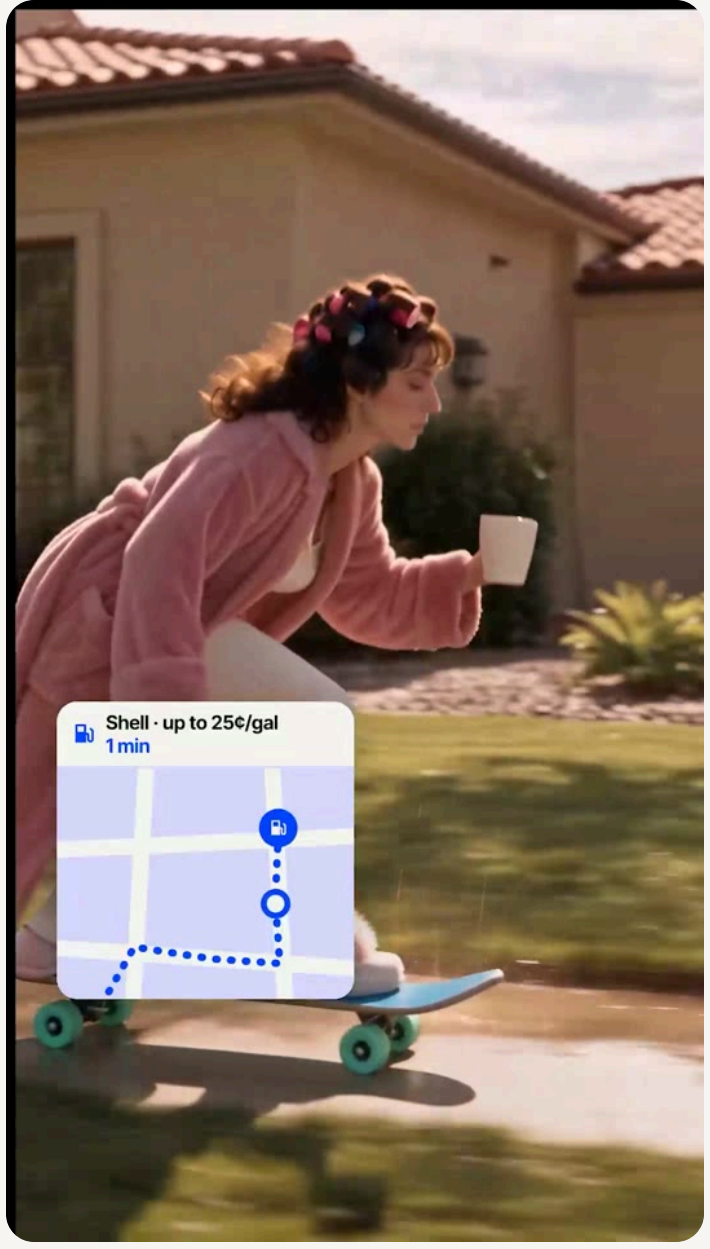
She claims the offer on her phone while running out of the door.

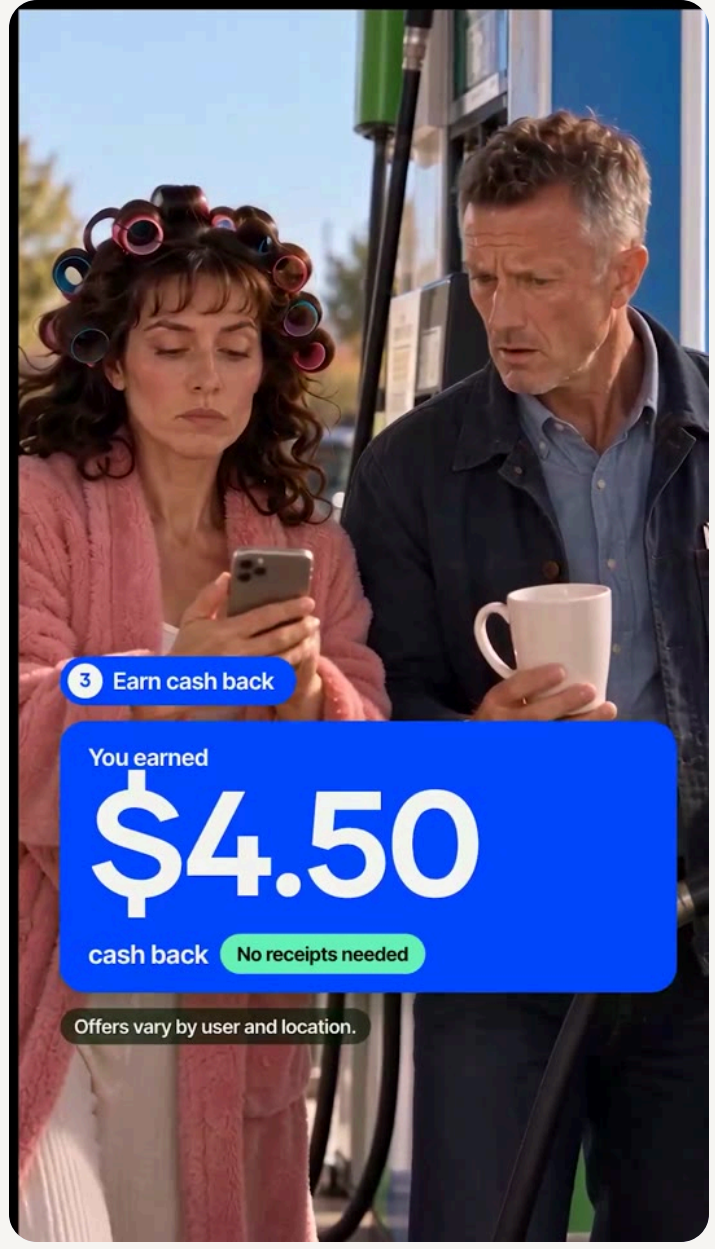
Copy

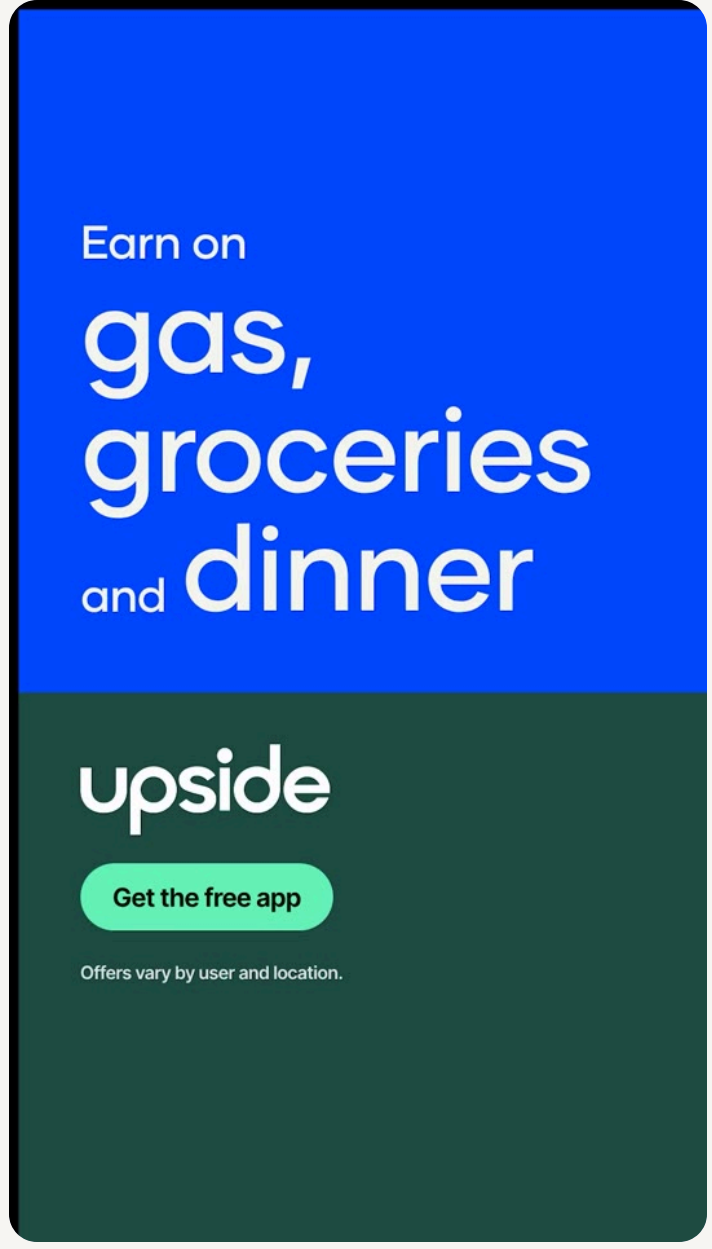
"1 Claim an offer" · "Up to 25¢/gal cash back"

Visual idea

Offer notification, then the claim card taps to "Claimed".







FRAME 4 · CHASE

What happens

She jumps on a skateboard, coffee in hand, and races to the station.

Copy

Map card: "Shell · up to 25¢/gal · 3 min"

Visual idea

A mini map with a live ETA. The comic peak of the film.

FRAME 5 · EARN

What happens

At the pump Dave pays like always. She shows him the phone and he lights up.

Copy

"2 Pay like always" · "3 Earn cash back" · "You earned $4.50 · No receipts needed"

Visual idea

A counter rolls from $0.00 to $4.50 and lands with a bounce.

FRAME 6 · VOW AND END CARD

What happens

Kinetic type closes the joke, then the end card.

Copy

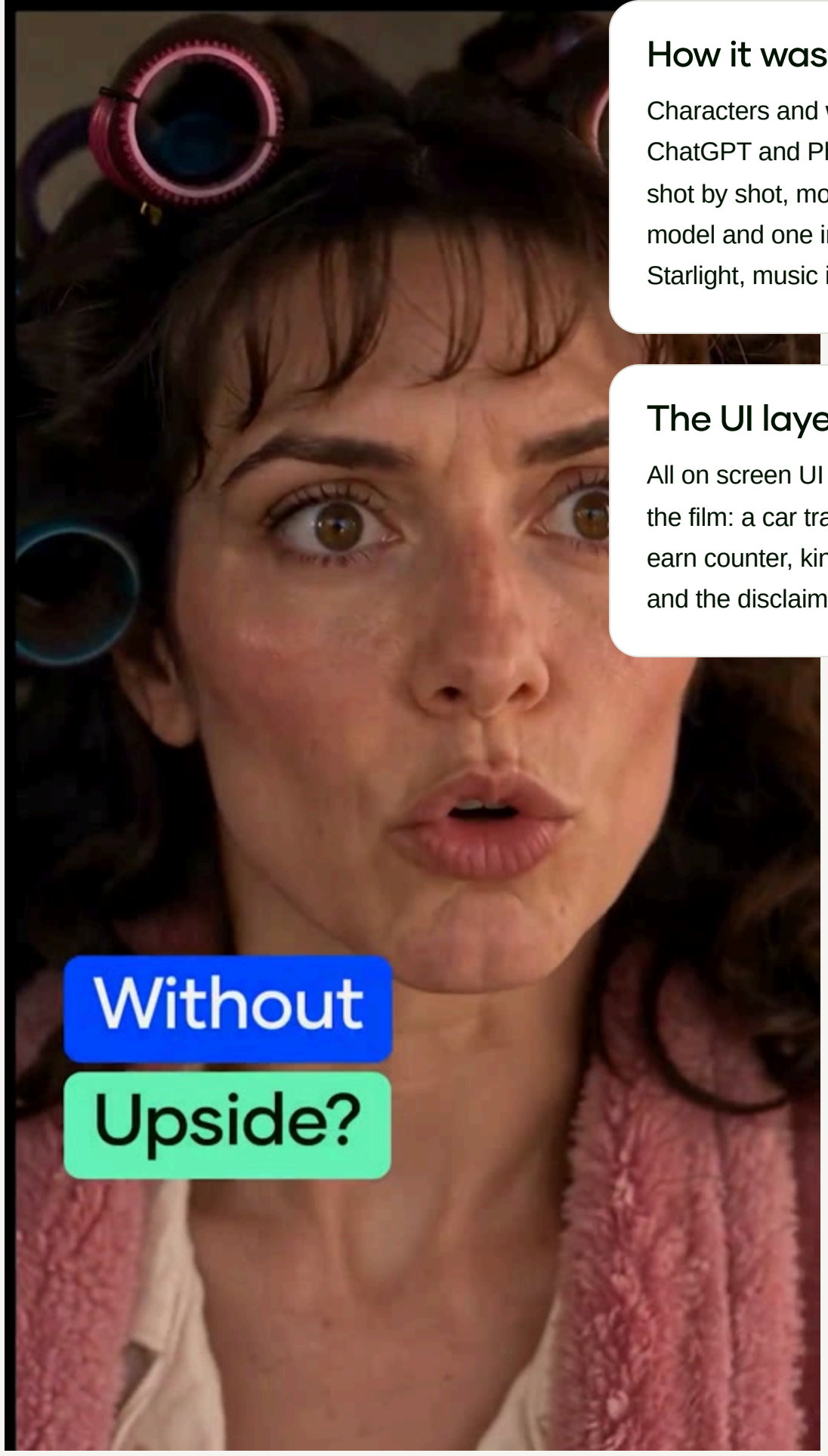
"Till cash back do us part" · "Earn on gas, groceries and dinner" · "Get the free app"

Visual idea

Letters pop and fall upward. Keywords grow and settle on a Swiss grid with the wordmark.

PART 5 · VIDEO PRODUCTION

The finished film



How it was made

Characters and world were designed in Midjourney, prepared for animation in ChatGPT and Photoshop with a character sheet and moodboard, and animated shot by shot, mostly in Seedance through Runway, with some shots in Google's model and one in Kling. Edited by hand in Premiere, upscaled to 4K with Topaz Starlight, music in Suno and final finishing in After Effects.

The UI layer

All on screen UI and copy was built as code and rendered frame by frame over the film: a car tracked with OpenCV, notification, claim card, live map, the $4.50 earn counter, kinetic closer and end card. Gilmer, Inter Tight, the book wordmark and the disclaimer on every offer frame.

PART 5 · BEHIND THE FILM

Building the world before the motion

Every shot started as a still. Characters were designed in Midjourney, then locked with character sheets so the faces, wardrobe and props stay the same across three video models. Key frames were prepared in ChatGPT and Photoshop, including the app screen, before animation.

Character sheet · Her. Front, three quarter and profile, close up, expressions, and the props: white mug, Electric Blue board with Pulse green wheels.

Key frames. The ride, the claim moment and the app screen with the Claim button, prepared as stills for animation.

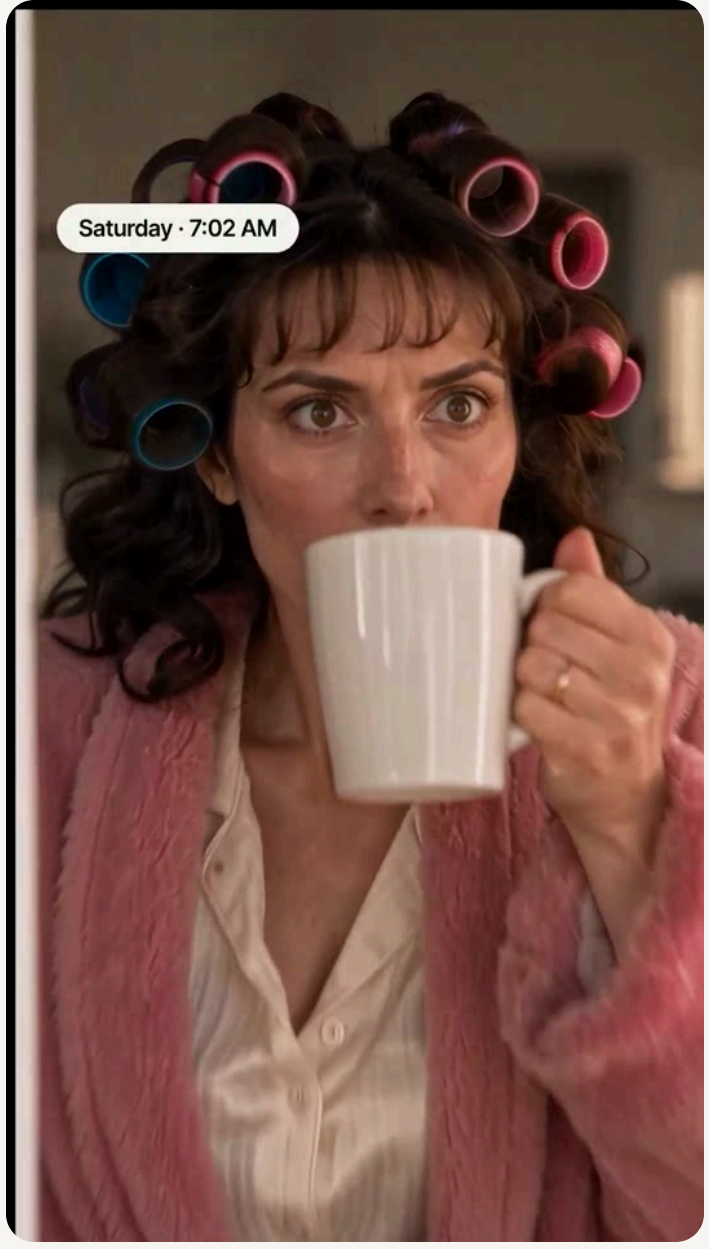
Character sheet · Dave. Outfit details, six expressions and the setting, so he reads the same in every shot.

World. A sunny American suburb as the location reference for every outdoor shot.

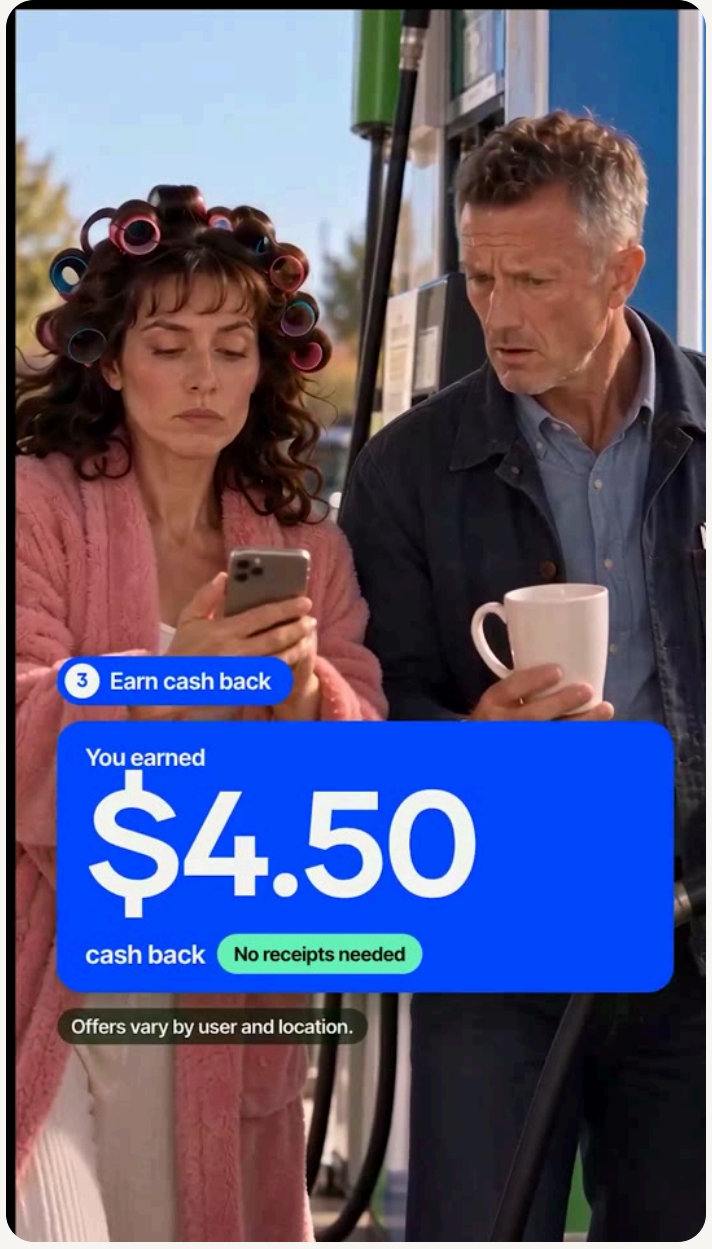
PART 6 · VIDEO HOOKS

Three openings to test

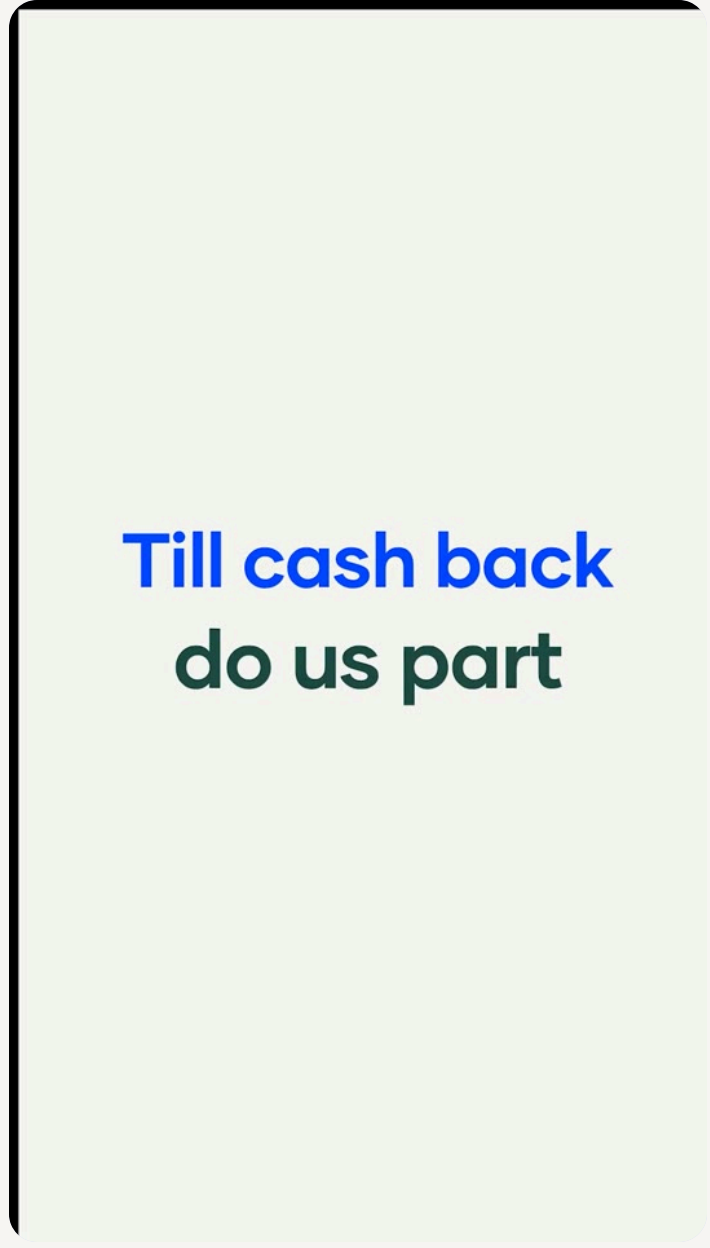
The final film, three different first seconds. Each tests a different reason to stop scrolling. The previews show the first 9 seconds.



Hook A · The stare. Opens on her face and "Saturday · 7:02 AM". Tests curiosity and character.



Hook B · Flash forward. Opens on the $4.50 earn moment, then rewinds to the morning. Tests reward first.



Hook C · The vow. Opens on the kinetic line "Till cash back do us part". Tests the joke and the brand line first.

PROCESS NOTES

How I got there

Tools and why

TOOL	USED FOR	WHY THIS TOOL
Claude	Brief cracking, creative research, a custom Upside brand skill, UI animation over the film, statics, variations, motion piece, brand audits	One agent that reads the brand book and writes the code, so every frame is built from the real fonts, logo and colour values and can be checked by measurement
Midjourney	Characters and world design	Strongest control of look and casting for a believable, saturated "real people" style
ChatGPT + Photoshop	Image creation for the static ads with Claude, compositing the photography banners in Photoshop, fixing and preparing stills for animation, character sheet, moodboard, script polish	Fast precise edits on single frames before they go to video
Seedance via Runway	Most of the animated shots	Best character consistency and motion for comedic physical action
Google video model	Selected shots	Better results on specific camera moves and lighting
Kling	One shot	Handled the action that the others could not
Premiere	Edit	Frame accurate comedic timing
After Effects	Final finishing of the film	Polish, music sync and last fixes on the master
Suno	Music	An original track timed to the edit
Topaz Starlight	4K upscale	The generated film was 480×854; overlays need a sharp plate
Playwright, ffmpeg, OpenCV	Frame rendering, compositing, car tracking, hooks	Pixel exact control and repeatable renders

Key prompts

Main character (Midjourney)

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Ultra-photorealistic cinematic fashion casting portrait of an effortlessly chic 35-year-old American woman, a charismatic fashion guru with the confident attitude of a high-end fashion editor.
Striking but natural facial features, expressive almond-shaped brown eyes, defined cheekbones, full lips, beautifully groomed eyebrows, luminous realistic skin, rich brunette hair styled in large colorful vintage hair rollers.
She wears a luxurious powder-blue silk dressing gown with elegant tailoring, delicate gold jewelry, oversized glamorous sunglasses resting on her head, and a perfectly coordinated pajama set underneath.
She holds a white takeaway coffee cup with casual confidence.
Her expression is cool, intelligent, subtly amused and completely self-assured. She radiates the energy of a woman who could turn an ordinary suburban driveway into a Paris Fashion Week runway.
A beautiful upscale American suburban home in the softly blurred background, early morning natural sunlight, sophisticated contemporary fashion editorial photography combined with grounded Hollywood action-comedy realism.
Medium portrait, 50mm lens, f/2.8, realistic skin pores, subtle film grain, premium wardrobe textures, cinematic color grading, believable human proportions, no exaggerated facial features, no cartoon, no illustration, no text, no watermark, 16:9.
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Film shot 01 · The Realization (Seedance, written with ChatGPT) The opening, kitchen window and the departing SUV. Focus: cinematic direction, performance and shot continuity.

```
Create a 10-second, ultra-photorealistic live-action opening sequence for a fast-paced Hollywood action-comedy commercial.

Use the provided character and environment references.

Preserve the woman's EXACT facial identity, dark brunette hair with colorful rollers, dusty-pink terry bathrobe, plain white cotton shirt, long cream pajama trousers and simple flat pink house slippers.

LOCATION: An authentic suburban family home in Minnesota on an early-summer morning. Natural daylight, mature trees, green lawns and a quiet residential street.

SHOT 1 | 0:00–0:03 | THE INTERRUPTION

Medium close-up, 50mm lens.

The woman stands near the kitchen window, holding a plain white ceramic coffee mug in her LEFT hand.

As she raises the mug toward her mouth, she hears her husband's car starting outside.

Her eyes dart toward the window. She turns her head quickly, interrupted mid-sip.

A short, controlled camera push-in captures the sudden change in her expression.

HARD CUT.

SHOT 2 | 0:03–0:05 | THE DEPARTURE

Dynamic POV through the kitchen window.

A dark gray family SUV is pulling out of the driveway.

The camera reacts with a quick, natural pan, following the departing vehicle.

Realistic vehicle acceleration, wheel rotation and suspension movement.

HARD CUT.

SHOT 3 | 0:05–0:10 | THE REALIZATION

Tight close-up, 85mm lens.

The woman realizes her husband is about to buy gas without claiming their Upside offer first.

Her expression shifts instantly from relaxed to focused.

She lowers the mug, mutters a quick "No, no, no," then spins away from the window and rushes toward the front door.

The camera follows with an energetic whip pan and short handheld tracking movement.

She nearly clips a chair, makes an instinctive sidestep and continues without slowing down.

CAMERA AND PERFORMANCE:

Precise, energetic Hollywood action-comedy cinematography.

Fast, spontaneous human movement with believable weight and momentum.

Natural camera reactions, realistic motion blur, sharp motivated cuts.

No robotic gestures, exaggerated expressions, floating camera movements or slow motion.
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CONTINUITY:

The coffee mug remains in her LEFT hand. Her smartphone stays in her bathrobe pocket.

Preserve her exact identity and wardrobe throughout.

Vertical 9:16. Premium cinematic realism.
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Film shot 02 · The Water Jump (Seedance, written with ChatGPT) The skateboard ollie over the sprinkler. Focus: action choreography, motion physics and visual comedy.

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Continue directly from the previous skateboard chase as a single continuous, ultra-photorealistic Hollywood action-comedy sequence.

DURATION: 10 seconds.
FORMAT: Vertical 9:16.

Preserve the woman's EXACT facial identity, colorful hair rollers, dusty-pink terry bathrobe, white cotton shirt, long cream pajama trousers and flat pink slippers.

She rides the same Electric Blue skateboard with mint-green wheels and carries a white ceramic coffee mug in her LEFT hand.

LOCATION: A leafy residential neighborhood in Minnesota, early-summer morning.

ACTION:

0:00–0:02 | THE APPROACH

The woman charges forward with real speed and determination.

She gives one powerful push with her RIGHT foot, places it back on the board and leans into the ride.

Her knees flex, shoulders shift and bathrobe flutters naturally.

The camera races alongside her, low to the ground.

0:02–0:04 | THE OBSTACLE

A neighbor watering his front lawn accidentally sweeps a stream of water across the sidewalk.

She spots the obstacle at the last possible moment.

Her eyes sharpen. She drops her center of gravity, bends both knees and prepares to jump.

The neighbor recoils in surprise.

0:04–0:06 | THE JUMP

In one explosive, physically coordinated motion, she performs a quick skateboard ollie over the water stream.

Both feet remain planted on the board.

Her free RIGHT arm extends outward for balance.

The sudden movement makes a small amount of coffee rise out of the mug in a realistic airborne arc.

For one thrilling instant, the woman, skateboard and coffee are airborne together.

No floating or slow motion.

0:06–0:08 | THE LANDING

She lands firmly on all four wheels.

Her knees absorb the impact naturally.

She instinctively adjusts the mug beneath the falling coffee so that most of the liquid returns to the cup through gravity and hand movement.

A few droplets escape.

The skateboard continues rolling rapidly.

0:08–0:10 | THE PAYOFF

She straightens up and gives a brief, genuinely pleased, slightly smug smile.

Without slowing down, she leans into her next turn and accelerates out of frame.

CAMERA:

28mm full-frame cinema lens.
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Fast, low-angle tracking camera approximately 45 cm above the ground.

Reactive camera adjustment as the water enters her path.

Quick natural tilt during the jump, followed by a subtle physical jolt on landing.

PERFORMANCE:

Athletic, spontaneous, daring and deadpan.

Constant natural body movement: shoulder shifts, knee compression, weight transfers and balance corrections.

PHYSICS:

Realistic skateboard momentum and wheel rotation.

Natural body weight, gravity, fabric movement and water interaction.

The coffee must follow physically plausible motion rather than magically reversing direction.

No robotic movement, impossible anatomy, floating objects, artificial water behavior or facial morphing.

Film shot 03 · The Last-Second Save (Seedance, written with ChatGPT) The gas station save and the coffee handoff. Focus: character interaction, dialogue timing and prop continuity.

Continue directly from the dramatic skateboard arrival at the gas station.

Create a fast, spontaneous, ultra-photorealistic Hollywood action-comedy scene.

DURATION: 10 seconds.
FORMAT: Vertical 9:16.

CHARACTER CONTINUITY:

Preserve the woman's EXACT established facial identity, colorful hair rollers, dusty-pink terry bathrobe, white shirt, long cream pajama trousers and flat pink slippers.

Preserve the husband's established appearance: middle-aged man with short graying hair, dark navy casual jacket, light blue shirt and dark jeans.

The same dark gray SUV is parked beside the gas pump.

The woman holds a normal-sized smartphone in her RIGHT hand, with its screen facing her.

She holds ONE plain white ceramic mug in her LEFT hand.

The mug contains a small, clearly visible amount of dark-brown coffee.

ACTION:

0:00–0:01.5 | BABE?!

The husband hears her dramatic skateboard stop.

He jolts, turns sharply and takes a small instinctive step backward.

He blurts out, genuinely shocked:

HUSBAND: "BABE?!"

His reaction is immediate, surprised and unplanned.

0:01.5–0:03.5 | DON'T PUMP!

The woman is still energized and slightly breathless from the chase.

She plants one foot firmly on the ground, leans toward him and interrupts in a single urgent burst:

WIFE: "NO! DON'T PUMP! WE'VE GOT UPSIDE!"

Her shoulders and hands move naturally with the intensity of the moment.

The coffee visibly moves inside the mug as she gestures.

0:03.5–0:06.5 | THE COFFEE HANDOFF

Without stopping to explain, she quickly extends the coffee mug toward her husband.

He instinctively reaches out and takes the SAME mug by its handle.

For a brief moment, both characters touch the same object.

His fingers close securely around the handle before she releases her grip.

She withdraws her LEFT hand, which is now completely empty.

The husband becomes the only person holding the mug.

The small amount of coffee inside reacts naturally to the movement.

0:06.5–0:08 | THE CLAIM

She shifts her attention to her smartphone.

The screen faces HER, not the camera.

She makes one purposeful tap, then angles the phone slightly toward her husband.

He leans forward to look.

His expression begins to change from confusion to understanding.

The authentic Upside app interface will be inserted during post-production.

0:08–0:10 | THE PUNCHLINE

His expression transforms into genuine admiration.

He gives a brief spontaneous laugh and says:

HUSBAND: "You're a genius."

She responds with a tiny, satisfied smile.

The moment feels affectionate, witty and completely natural.

CAMERA:

35mm full-frame lens.

Dynamic medium two-shot with subtle handheld energy.

Maintain clear visibility of both faces and the mug during the handoff.

A small reactive camera adjustment follows the husband's initial surprise.

Finish with a subtle push-in on the husband's expression.

PERFORMANCE:

The characters must react to each other naturally, with overlapping gestures, spontaneous eye movements and believable physical timing.

Avoid synchronized acting, frozen poses, theatrical expressions and robotic movements.

STRICT OBJECT CONTINUITY:

Exactly ONE coffee mug exists throughout the scene.

The mug physically transfers from the woman's LEFT hand to the husband's hand.

No duplicated cups, disappearing objects, distorted fingers or impossible hand positions.

The smartphone remains realistically proportioned.

VISUAL STYLE:

Authentic suburban Minnesota gas station, natural early-summer morning light and restrained brand-blue environmental accents.

Real human skin texture, natural fabric movement and subtle cinematic film grain.

Brand skill (to Claude)

Before we start the creative, build me a careful and precise skill for the brand. I'll attach the font, the brand book and the brief. Put into the skill After Effects knowledge you find online.

Motion direction (to Claude)

More interest, it feels like a presentation. Change top and bottom, one slide closes and the next starts with a word that grows and shrinks. Like After Effects, young, pop, dynamic, fun, colours change, all within the brand.

Iterations

LOGO

STATICS

First: the logo from the website, with the U icon locked up next to the wordmark.

Kept: the wordmark file extracted from the brand book, never locked up with the icon, in approved colourways only. Checked at 96 to 98% pixel match.

First: photo crops from the film with heavy colour blocks. The 480p source looked soft and the blocks felt heavy.

Kept: a clean Swiss grid with Upside's own illustration library, two type sizes, and one Pulse accent.

PHOTOGRAPHY BANNERS

First: automatic cutouts of her from the film. Edges looked cut out and pasted on.

Kept: the layout built as code with an open photo card, and every frame composited by hand in Photoshop so the photo and the type sit together.

ILLUSTRATION

First: new figures drawn by hand in vector. They looked stiff and off brand.

Kept: only figures from Upside's illustration library, recoloured for dark backgrounds, so every character comes from the same illustrator.

MOTION

First: a camera pan across the slides. It felt like a presentation.

Kept: kinetic word beats, iris reveals, colour band wipes, and a skater and a car that pull the thread into the next scene.

Problems and fixes

PROBLEM	FIX
Low resolution film	The generated film was 480×854. Upscaled to 4K in Topaz Starlight before compositing the UI.
Cut points moved between versions	Each recut shifted the shots by fractions of a second. Scene detection on both versions, then the overlay timeline was remapped cut by cut.
Wrong logo and font weight	Audit against the book found the website icon and Gilmer Bold. Replaced with book files and Gilmer Medium, UI in Inter Tight, tracking −20 everywhere.
Rough cutouts	Background removal broke motion blurred hands. Switched to framed photos with a head pop out, then to the illustration library.
Dash like marks in the motion	Elements that scaled up from zero looked like thin lines for a frame. They now fade in only at real size; every entrance checked frame by frame.
Waving arm detached	The cut arm rotated around the wrong pivot and left a smear. Replaced with a gentle sway of the whole figure.

Time per part

PART	TIME	NOTES
Part 1 · Platform	3 h	Brief, brand book, site and competitor research, concept routes
Part 2 · Static ads	Longest part	Image creation took the most time of the whole project, largely with Claude and ChatGPT: three directions, brand audits and the illustration work
Part 3 · Variations	10 h	Together with Part 6: variation engine, copy testing plan, brand checks and review
Part 4 · Storyboard	1.5 h	Script and storyboard
Part 5 · Video	16 h	12+ h film generation and edit, then UI animation, music and After Effects finishing
Part 6 · Hooks	incl. in Part 3	Three openings cut from the master

With paid tools

Train a character model of the couple so every shot keeps the same faces, and generate natively in 4K instead of upscaling.

Finish the UI layer in After Effects with the brand skill's scripts, export Lottie files for the app team, and add a licensed voice over.

Run the variation engine into a creative testing tool and let real performance data pick the next round of hooks and colourways.

Offers vary by user and location.